

FREE DOWNLOAD

The 3-Tier Pitch

so you always know what to say.

Three ready-made ways to answer "so what do you do?" Matched to the size of the moment, not how loud you need to be.

✓ Free download ✓ No fluff ✓ Built for reluctant networkers

BY REBECCA COOPER

A word before you start.

If you've ever frozen when someone asked "so what do you do?", or talked yourself out of a room you knew you should walk into, this is for you.



I work with SME business owners, leadership teams, founders, and people just getting started, and the same thing trips almost everyone up: knowing what to say when someone asks. My own background is in recruitment, twenty years of it, where networking was survival and nobody ever taught me how to do it in a way that worked for me. So I built my own system, tested it across the people I work with, and kept what actually worked.

The 3-Tier Pitch is the first piece of it, three ready-made ways to answer the question that trips almost everyone up, matched to how much time you've actually got.

You don't need to be the loudest person in the room. You need to be clear about who you are and what you do. You're already excellent at the work, this just gives the words somewhere to land.

Becc

INSIDE THIS DOWNLOAD

One pitch was never going to work everywhere

Here's what to use instead.

Most people have exactly one way of describing what they do, and use it whether they've got ten seconds or ten minutes. A hallway "so what do you do?" needs a completely different answer to a room that's just gone quiet and turned to you.

TIER 1

Cocktail Pitch

For the passing "so what do you do", before the event's even started.

10 seconds · full script ahead

TIER 2

Round Table Pitch

For when it's your turn to introduce yourself to the group.

30–60 seconds · full script ahead

TIER 3

Deep Dive

For when someone leans in and says "tell me more."

2–3 minutes · full script ahead

Three tiers. One conversation, whatever the room gives you.

TIER 1

Cocktail Pitch

10 seconds

Use it when someone asks what you do in passing, a breakout room, before the event officially starts, a casual moment where a paragraph would be too much.

1 Who

The person you help, in plain terms, not a job title.

2 Stuck on what

The problem or moment they're stuck in right now.

3 So they can

The outcome, what actually changes for them.

Why it works: *warmth is judged before competence, people read who you help before any credential could land.*

Asch (1946); Willis & Todorov, Princeton University (2006)

"I help people who struggle with networking actually get something from it, without it draining them."

TIER 2

Round Table Pitch

30 to 60 seconds

Use it when it's your turn to introduce yourself to the group. Say it naturally, don't rush it, and don't read it off your phone.

1 Your Cocktail Pitch

Start with the line from Tier 1.

2 One line of why

A sentence of story, not your full history.

3 A genuine question

Something they could actually answer, not a rhetorical close.

Why it works: *conversations deepen through reciprocal exchange, one person opens, the other responds. A real question triggers that far better than a tidy close.*

Social Penetration Theory (Altman & Taylor); Simply Psychology (2026)

"Hi, I'm Rebecca. I help people who struggle with networking actually get something from it, without it draining them. I've spent 20 years in recruitment, where this was basically survival, but nobody ever showed me how to do it in a way that worked for me. So I built a system, and I'm testing it on myself at this event today. Can I ask, does networking come naturally to you?"

Watch out for: a closed or rhetorical question. Ask it, then actually stop talking.

TIER 3

Deep Dive

2 to 3 minutes

Use it when someone leans in and says "oh that's interesting, tell me more." This is a conversation now, not a pitch, so let it breathe.

1 The struggle

What it looks like before someone finds you.

2 The turn

The moment things start to shift.

3 The invitation

Where they can find out more, never a hard close.

Why it works: *sharing a real struggle, at a moderate depth, invites the other person to open up in return. A polished pitch does the opposite.*

Altman & Taylor, Social Penetration Theory

"The people I work with know they need to get out there, but they scroll past events, or they book something and talk themselves out of going. Then if they do go, they come home exhausted, overthinking every conversation. That cycle is exactly what I built my system to solve. It's for people who aren't naturally 'networkers', because I'm one of them."

Watch out for: skipping straight to your service. If it starts to sound like a sales pitch, slow back down to the struggle.

Your *Turn*

Use this space to build your own. Remember, don't overcomplicate it, say it out loud when you're done.

TIER 1

10 sec

Cocktail Pitch

"I help ___ who ___, so they can ___."

TIER 2

30–60 sec

Round Table Pitch

One line of why:

Your genuine question:

TIER 3

2–3 min

Deep Dive

The struggle:

The turn:

The invitation:

Hey there, I'm Becs.

I work with SME business owners, leadership teams, founders, and people just getting started, the ones who are excellent at what they do but avoid the room. I help them build a system that actually fits how they're wired.

- Worked with founders, leadership teams and SME owners across sectors
- 20 years in recruitment, where networking was survival
- EMCC governed coach, ILM Level 5, qualified life coach

Becs



YOUR NEXT STEP

Come say it out loud.

Network Your Way live sessions run monthly. Bring your 3-Tier Pitch, practise it out loud, get feedback, and meet people building the same skill.

Save my spot for the next session →

networkyourway.com/live-sessions